

MK PARRISH • FREE RESOURCE

THE HOMEPAGE LEAK MAP

Nine places your site loses the right buyer before the call.

BY MK PARRISH

HOW TO USE THIS

Open your homepage. Not the draft. Not the version in your head. The live one.

Then walk through these nine leaks in order. Mark each one as **clear**, **weak**, or **missing**. Do not be generous. Your homepage does not need encouragement. It needs a read.

Most websites do not fail because they are ugly. They fail because the visitor has to work too hard to understand three things:

- why this matters now
- why you are the person or company to trust
- what to do next

If the page makes a capable buyer feel effort, they leave. That is the leak.

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A homepage is not a biography. It is a decision path.

1. THE FIRST FIVE SECONDS

The test: In five seconds, can a stranger tell what you do, who it is for, and why it matters?

The leak: A poetic headline with no job. It sounds expensive, but it does not help anyone decide.

Fix it: Write the blunt version first: "I help [person] do [specific result] without [specific pain]." Then make it sound like you.

2. THE READER

The test: Does the page name the person who should care?

The leak: Copy that talks to "brands," "leaders," "creatives," or "businesses" without making one real human feel caught.

Fix it: Add one sentence that describes the buyer's current moment so specifically they feel seen before they feel sold.

3. THE STAKES

The test: Does the page say what it costs to leave the problem alone?

The leak: You describe the service, but not the consequence of waiting. No urgency means no movement.

Fix it: Name the hidden cost: missed calls, weak positioning, unclear offers, slow pipeline, wasted traffic, or the reputation gap.

4. THE OFFER PATH

The test: Can the visitor choose the right path without reading the whole site?

The leak: Services are buried, split into too many categories, or explained like an internal menu.

Fix it: Give three doors max: hire you, buy the framework, or read/join/listen first. Make the next step obvious.

5. THE PROOF

The test: Is proof sitting near the claim it supports?

The leak: Big claims float alone. Testimonials sit in a separate section. Numbers appear without context.

Fix it: Pair claim and proof. If you say "pipeline," show a number. If you say "voice," show a before/after. If you say "senior," show the scope.

6. THE VOICE

The test: Could this page only come from you?

The leak: The copy is technically correct but emotionally anonymous. It could wear a competitor's logo and survive.

Fix it: Add the sentence you were nervous to say. The line with taste in it. The one a committee would soften.

7. THE CTA

The test: Is there one dominant next step at each decision point?

The leak: The visitor gets "book," "subscribe," "shop," "follow," "learn more," and "contact" all at once.

Fix it: Each section gets one primary action. Secondary actions can exist, but they should not fight the main door.

8. THE LEAD CAPTURE

The test: Does the free offer solve a problem the visitor actually has right now?

The leak: "Join my newsletter" asks for trust before earning it.

Fix it: Offer a diagnostic, checklist, template, or teardown that helps them see the problem more clearly today.

9. THE MOBILE READ

The test: On your phone, can someone scan the page without getting trapped in giant type, cramped buttons, or dense paragraphs?

The leak: The desktop concept survives, but the mobile decision path does not.

Fix it: Shorten paragraphs, keep buttons stable, make the first CTA visible without forcing a full scroll marathon.

WHAT TO FIX FIRST

If you marked **weak** or **missing** more than three times, do not start by redesigning the whole site. Start with the path.

1. Rewrite the hero in plain language.
2. Collapse the offers into fewer choices.
3. Put one useful lead magnet near the middle of the page.
4. Move proof closer to the promise.
5. Cut every line that sounds like it was approved by a committee.

You do not need a louder homepage. You need a clearer one.

THE ONE-SENTENCE REWRITE

Before you change anything else, finish this:

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"The reason the right buyer should stay on this page is..."

If you cannot finish that sentence without rambling, the page is not ready for design.
The strategy is still leaking.

Start there.

- MK Parrish

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